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End-to-end isolation over PCIe

Abstract

Examples systems are provided for isolating transactions originating from different types of applications, including systems for providing such isolation on an inbound side and systems for providing such isolation on an outbound side, as well as end-to-end isolation systems. Such systems may be implemented in a peripheral component interconnect express (PCIe) environment. On an outbound side, a first interconnect receives transactions having different attributes indicating different application origins, respectively, and selects different pathways for the transactions based on their respective attributes. On an inbound side, a second interconnect selects different pathways for the transactions based on their respective attributes. Thus, transactions originating from safety and non-safety applications may be kept isolated as they are routed, and a non-safety transaction may be restricted from accessing certain portions of memory.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/135,129, filed Dec. 28, 2020, which claims priority to Indian Provisional Patent Application No. 201941054201, filed Dec. 27, 2019, each of which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(2) Peripheral component interconnect express (PCIe) is a high-speed serial interface standard. A PCIe implementation uses serial links to connect a host (known as a root complex (RC)) to switches and endpoints. An endpoint provides one or more functionalities, such as memory access, to a host system with an RC. The endpoints can be connected directly to the RC or through a switch. A switch is useful when more than one endpoint is connected to the RC.

SUMMARY

(3) In an example, a system includes a demultiplexer, an access controller, and a memory having a first region and a second region. The demultiplexer is configured to receive a transaction that includes a requester identification (ID), a traffic class, and an address, and is further configured to determine a channel, among a plurality of channels, based on the traffic class of the transaction.

Each channel is associated with a corresponding mapping table. The access controller is configured to obtain, based at least in part on the requester ID, a context ID from the mapping table corresponding to the channel determined by the demultiplexer. The access controller is further configured to allow the transaction to access the first region of the memory, the first region corresponding to the context ID, and block access to the second region based on the context ID.

(4) In another example, a system includes a plurality of applications, an access controller, a plurality of ports, each having a traffic class and coupled to the access controller, and a multiplexer coupled to the plurality of ports. Each application is of a respective type, and each is configured to generate transactions. Each transaction includes an attribute indicating the type of application from which that transaction originated and a target address. The access controller is configured to, for a particular transaction among the transactions generated: determine the type of application from which the particular transaction originated; select a port, among the plurality of ports, based on the type of application from which the particular transaction originated; and forward the particular transaction to the selected port. The selected port is configured to transmit the particular transaction to the multiplexer; and the multiplexer is configured to obtain a channel corresponding to the traffic class of the port selected, and transmit the particular transaction through outbound port circuitry for the channel.

(5) In still another example, a system includes a first interconnect and a second interconnect. The first interconnect is configured to: receive a first transaction having a first attribute indicating that the first transaction originated from a first type of application, receive a second transaction having a second attribute indicating that the second transaction originated from a second type of application, select a first pathway to route the first transaction through the first interconnect based on the first attribute, and select a second pathway to route the second transaction through the first interconnect based on the second attribute. The second interconnect is configured to: select a third pathway to route the first transaction through the second interconnect based on the first attribute, and select a fourth pathway to route the second transaction through the second interconnect based on the second attribute.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system for providing end-to-end isolation over PCIe in accordance with various examples.

(2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a system-on-chip (SoC) for providing end-to-end isolation over PCIe in accordance with various examples.

(3) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an inbound safety isolation unit in accordance with various examples.

(4) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an outbound safety isolation unit in accordance with various

examples.

(5) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of a system for providing end-to-end quality of service (QoS) over PCIe in accordance with various examples.

(6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of a method for handling an inbound PCIe transaction in accordance with various examples.

(7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart of a method for handling an outbound PCIe transaction in accordance with various examples.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) PCIe is useful in distributed processing systems that carry high processing requirements, such as in automated driving applications. In some such systems, multiple SoCs connect to each other using PCIe, with each of the SoCs being capable of carrying a high processing load. Each SoC may execute multiple applications. Some of these applications may be used for critical tasks such as safety applications (e.g., analytics), while other applications may be used for non-safety applications that are less critical, such as processing graphics or displaying information.

(9) For safety applications, a technique called end-to-end isolation provides many benefits. End-to-end isolation entails keeping transactions for one application separate from transactions for another application throughout the entirety of the system. End-to-end isolation also includes isolating memory space so an application can only access memory space that the application is authorized to access. In addition, end-to-end isolation enables data packets for critical applications to be prioritized.

(10) Implementing end-to-end isolation in multi-SoC distributed processing systems, however, is challenging. One approach to provide end-to-end isolation in such systems is for each application on an SoC to be implemented as an independent PCIe device. For example, a safety application could be a first PCIe device, and a non-safety application could be a second PCIe device. A second approach to provide end-to-end isolation in such systems is for each application to be implemented as an independent PCIe function on an SoC. However, both of these approaches increase costs and achieve only partial isolation.

(11) This disclosure describes various examples of a distributed system that resolves the challenges described above. In some examples, the distributed system includes multiple SoCs connected using PCIe. For purposes of this description, two SoCs are assumed, although any number of SoCs may be used. One SoC is an RC, and the other SoC is an endpoint. End-to-end isolation is provided for inbound and outbound traffic for both SoCs, meaning that transactions (e.g., data) from safety and non-safety applications are isolated from each other throughout the system. As described below, end-to-end isolation may be achieved using an Inbound Safety Isolation Unit (to facilitate isolation for transactions being received by an SoC) and an Outbound Safety Isolation Unit (to facilitate isolation for transactions being transmitted by an SoC) on each of the SoCs of the distributed system. Quality of Service (QoS) support, which enables the prioritization of packets and bandwidth, is also provided end-to-end, from an application on a first SoC, through an interconnect on the first SoC, through a PCIe link, through an interconnect on a second SoC, and to another application on the second SoC. QoS support may be achieved using PCIe features that enable the segregation of transaction traffic based on priority (e.g., with safety application transactions being prioritized over non-safety application transactions). Unlike the approaches described above, applications are not implemented as independent PCIe devices or independent PCIe functions, and thus the negative consequences of those approaches are mitigated. Examples of the distributed system are described below with reference to FIGS. 1-7, preceded by a description of terminology relevant to the distributed system.

(12) In a PCIe system, each device has a unique PCIe identifier (ID). Thus, traffic from different PCIe devices may be isolated using the PCIe ID associated with that traffic. As described above, PCIe systems also provide a traffic prioritization feature called QoS support. QoS refers to the capability to route transactions from different applications using differing priority levels and

bandwidth allocations. For example, some transactions (e.g., from safety applications) may receive higher priority and guaranteed bandwidth, while other transactions (e.g., from non-safety applications) may not have specific bandwidth or latency requirements.

(13) PCIe systems may implement QoS using features called traffic classes (TCs) and virtual channels (VCs). TCs are categories of transactions that the PCIe system disclosed herein assigns to transactions based on the priority level of that transaction. For example, a TC number of 7 may be assigned to transactions arising from safety applications, while a TC number of 0 may be assigned to transactions arising from non-safety applications. In examples, transactions bearing higher TC numbers are granted preferential treatment within the PCIe system over transactions bearing lower TC numbers.

(14) VCs are virtual constructs used in a PCIe system to arbitrate access to network hardware resources (e.g., hardware channels, buffers, etc.) that transactions use—for example, to flow from one SoC to another. For example, a pair of SoCs in a PCIe system may communicate via a PCIe link with limited hardware channels on the link. In this example, one of the SoCs may use a VC scheme to arbitrate (e.g., multiplex) which transactions gain access to the hardware channels on the PCIe link, how they are transmitted, and when they are transmitted. The PCIe standard defines eight TCs and eight VCs, although the scope of this disclosure is not strictly limited as such. Examples of the PCIe system described herein provide both end-to-end isolation and QoS, and these examples are now described with reference to FIGS. 1-7.

(15) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a PCIe system **100** for providing end-to-end isolation and QoS over PCIe in accordance with various examples. System **100** includes SoC1 **102** and SoC2 **104**. SoC1 **102** and SoC2 **104** each provide end-to-end isolation and QoS over PCIe according to an example herein. SoC1 **102** and SoC2 **104** each may include a number of components that are not expressly shown in FIG. 1. For example, SoC1 **102** and SoC2 **104** can each include one or more processors, co-processors, controllers, memories, input/output ports, secondary data storages, communication components, sensors, interfaces, digital signal processors, and other components.

(16) SoC1 **102** includes a PCIe RC **106**. RC **106** is a root complex that is configured to detect and configure devices connected to it. RC **106** generates transaction requests for SoC1 **102** and manages transactions according to the PCIe standard. SoC1 **102** also includes outbound safety isolation unit **108**, inbound safety isolation unit **110**, and QoS unit **112**. Examples of these units are described below. Outbound safety isolation unit **108** manages and provides isolation and QoS for transactions within SoC1 **102** until the transactions reach the PCIe link. Inbound safety isolation unit **110** manages and provides isolation and QoS for transactions that are received by SoC1 **102**. QoS unit **112** provides QoS for inbound and outbound transactions. Outbound safety isolation unit **108**, inbound safety isolation unit **110**, and QoS unit **112** can each include any combination of hardware and/or software to perform the functions described herein. Outbound safety isolation unit **108**, inbound safety isolation unit **110**, and QoS unit **112** may use the resources (processors, memory, etc.) of SoC1 **102** to perform these functions, or they may use their own dedicated resources in some examples. Outbound safety isolation unit **108**, inbound safety isolation unit **110**, and QoS unit **112** operate in conjunction with other components described herein to provide end-to-end isolation and QoS over PCIe.

(17) SoC1 **102** also includes two example applications, safety application **114** and non-safety application **116**. The safety application **114** and non-safety application **116** may include executable code stored on one or more memories (not expressly shown) in the SoC1 **102**. In one example, safety application **114** is an application related to an automotive safety function, such as an automated driving function or analytics. Safety application **114** is therefore a critical application in this example, and special processing conditions may apply for transactions from safety application **114**, such as a certain QoS level (e.g., priority level). Non-safety application **116** is an application that is not related to an automotive safety function in this example, and is not a critical application. Different processing conditions for transactions from non-safety application **116** may apply

compared to those provided for transactions from safety application **114**. In examples herein, any number of safety applications **114** or non-safety applications **116** may be executed on SoC1 **102** or SoC2 **104**. The scope of this description is not limited to safety and non-safety applications in the automotive context. Rather, any high-priority or critical application may be deemed a safety application and any low-priority or non-critical application may be deemed a non-safety application, irrespective of context.

(18) SoC1 **102** also includes interconnect **118**. Although FIG. **1** depicts interconnect **118** as a single, monolithic entity positioned between the applications **114**, **116** and the outbound safety isolation unit **130**, inbound safety isolation unit **132**, and QoS **134**, the interconnect **118** may be a distributed entity and/or in one or more positions relative to the remaining components of the SoC1 **102**. For example, despite the depiction in FIG. **1** of interconnect **118** in a specific location relative to other components of the SoC1 **102**, traffic may pass through the interconnect **118** each time it is passed from one component to another component in the SoC1 **102**.

(19) Interconnect **118** may include multiple ports for transmitting transactions and other traffic between components and applications within SoC1 **102**. Interconnect **118** can include ports dedicated for specific types of traffic, or ports dedicated to specific applications in some examples. Interconnect **118** can also include ports with one or more levels of priority in some examples. Thus, in some examples, the path a transaction takes through the interconnect **118** (e.g., the input and output ports of the interconnect **118** through which a transaction passes) may depend on an attribute associated with that transaction that indicates whether the transaction is from the safety application **114** or non-safety application **116**. The path that a transaction takes through the interconnect **118** may determine the priority, isolation, and QoS provided to that transaction. For example, as described in detail below, transactions assigned to specific ports in the interconnect **118** may be assigned a TC number based on those ports, and the TC number may be used in conjunction with corresponding VCs to provide priority, isolation, and QoS to those transactions.

(20) A number of arrows are shown in system **100** to represent transactions. In an example, the safety application **114** provides a safety transaction **120**, and the non-safety application **116** provides a non-safety transaction **122**. Arrows **120A**, **120B**, and **120C** represent an example path for transaction **120**. Arrows **122A**, **122B**, and **122C** represent an example path for transaction **122**. The transaction **120** is provided from safety application **114** to interconnect **118**, then to outbound safety isolation unit **108**, then to RC **106**. In another example, the transaction **120** is provided from safety application **114** to the outbound safety isolation unit **108**, then to the RC **106**, passing through the interconnect **118** one or more times. QoS **112** provides QoS for transaction **120**. For example, QoS **112** may map a TC to a port on interconnect **118**. Any transaction **120**, **122** subsequently passing through that port is assigned the TC of the port, and once that transaction **120**, **122** has been assigned the TC of the port, the transaction **120**, **122** receives the QoS and isolation associated with that TC.

(21) Upon reaching RC **106**, the transaction **120**, **122** is transmitted on PCIe link **124** to a destination, such as the SoC2 **104**. A PCIe QoS mechanism **126** (within the PCIe link **124**) may provide a QoS to the transaction **120**, **122** according to the PCIe standard during this transmission. The QoS within SoC1 **102** can be mapped to the QoS provided by the PCIe link **124** to enable a consistent end-to-end QoS for transactions, as described below. Therefore, a consistent QoS can be provided on each SoC1 **102**, **104** and on the PCIe link **124**. As shown in system **100** and described below, transactions **120** and **122** can also be isolated from one another end-to-end.

(22) In another example, inbound transactions entering SoC1 **102** (not shown in FIG. **1**) enter SoC1 **102** via RC **106** and are then received by inbound safety isolation unit **110**, where various operations are performed, as described below. The transaction is then provided to an application, memory, processor, or any appropriate destination. As described above for outbound transactions, the interconnect **118** facilitates the provision of the inbound transaction to the various components of the SoC1 **102**.

(23) In some examples, SoC2 **104** includes components similar to those of SoC1 **102**. SoC2 **104** acts as a multifunction endpoint device in this example, and it can have as much or even more functionality than SoC1 **102** in some examples. SoC2 **104** includes PCIe endpoint **128**, outbound safety isolation unit **130**, inbound safety isolation unit **132**, and QoS unit **134**. These units perform functions similar to their respective counterpart units in SoC1 **102**. Outbound safety isolation unit **130**, inbound safety isolation unit **132**, and QoS unit **134** can each include any combination of hardware and/or software to perform the functions described herein. Outbound safety isolation unit **130**, inbound safety isolation unit **132**, and QoS unit **134** can utilize the resources (processors, memory, etc.) of SoC2 **104** to perform these functions, or they may use own dedicated resources in some examples.

(24) SoC2 **104** also includes two example applications, safety application **136** and non-safety application **138** (e.g., executable code stored on one or more memories, which are not expressly shown). Like safety application **114**, in one example safety application **136** is an application related to an automotive safety function, such as an automated driving function or analytics. Safety application **136** is therefore a critical application in this example, and special processing conditions may apply for transactions from safety application **136**, such as a certain QoS level. Non-safety application **138** is an application that is not related to an automotive safety function in this example, and is not a critical application. As described above, the scope of this disclosure is not limited to automotive contexts.

(25) SoC2 **104** also includes interconnect **140**. Interconnect **140** may be similar to interconnect **118** in examples. Interconnect **140** may include multiple ports for transmitting transactions and other traffic between components and applications within SoC2 **104**. Interconnect **140** can include ports dedicated for specific types of traffic, or ports dedicated to specific applications in some examples. Interconnect **140** can also include ports with one or more levels of priority in some examples. As with the interconnect **118**, the interconnect **140** is depicted as a single, monolithic entity, but in at least some examples, the interconnect **140** may be a distributed entity and/or in one or more positions relative to the remaining components of the SoC2 **104**.

(26) Arrows **142A**, **142B**, and **142C** represent an example path for safety transaction **142**. Arrows **144A**, **144B**, and **144C** represent an example path for non-safety transaction **144**. In one example, transaction **142** is provided from safety application **136** to interconnect **140**, then to outbound safety isolation unit **130**, and then to endpoint **128**. In another example, the transaction **142** is provided from safety application **136** to the outbound safety isolation unit **130** and subsequently to the endpoint **128**, with the interconnect **140** facilitating the provision of the transaction **142** to one or more of these components. Similarly, in one example, the transaction **144** is provided from non-safety application **138** to interconnect **140**, then to outbound safety isolation unit **130**, and then to endpoint **128**. In another example, the transaction **144** is provided from the non-safety application **138** to the outbound safety isolation unit **130** and subsequently to the endpoint **128**, with the interconnect **140** facilitating the provision of the transaction **144** to one or more of these components. After reaching endpoint **128**, a transaction is transmitted on PCIe link **124** to a destination. The PCIe QoS mechanism **126** may provide a QoS according to the PCIe standard during this transmission. QoS **134** also provides quality of service for transactions **142** and **144**. Like QoS **112**, QoS **134** may assign a TC to a port on interconnect **140**. Transactions **142** and **144** receive the TC associated with the respective ports they use on interconnect **140**, and after having been assigned their respective TCs, they are provided with a specific QoS based on the assigned TC. As shown in system **100** and described below, transactions **142** and **144** can also be isolated from one another end-to-end.

(27) In some examples, inbound transactions entering SoC2 **104** (not shown in FIG. **1**) enter SoC2 **104** via endpoint **128** and are then received by inbound safety isolation unit **132**, where various operations are performed, as described below. The transaction is then provided to an application, memory, processor, or any appropriate destination by way of interconnect **140**.

(28) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of an example SoC 200 for providing end-to-end isolation and QoS over PCIe in accordance with various examples. SoC 200 could include either an RC like SoC1 102, or an endpoint like SoC2 104. SoC 200 includes a PCIe RC or endpoint 204, as shown. The components of SoC 200 operate similarly whether SoC 200 includes an RC 204 or an endpoint 204. SoC 200 includes outbound safety isolation unit 206, inbound safety isolation unit 208, QoS unit 210, and interconnect 212. These components of SoC 200 operate similarly to their respective counterpart components in FIG. 1. In this example, SoC 200 includes two example applications, safety application 214 and non-safety application 216. In other examples, any number of safety applications 214 or non-safety applications 216 may execute on SoC 200.

(29) Outbound safety isolation unit 206 includes port based channel selection 218, traffic access controller 220, application manager 222, and safety channel multiplexer 224. These units within outbound safety isolation unit 206 can each include any combination of hardware and/or software to perform the functions described herein. Each of these units performs a different function, and each such function is now described in turn.

(30) One example function of the outbound safety isolation unit (e.g., outbound safety isolation unit 206) is to assign TC numbers to specific ports of an interconnect. As described above, this action may also be performed by the QoS (e.g., QoS 112 and 134 in FIG. 1), and thus the outbound safety isolation unit and the QoS may perform this action individually or in cooperation with each other. In the context of FIG. 2, the outbound safety isolation unit 206 assigns different TC numbers to different ports of the interconnect 212. This function may be performed by the port based channel selection 218. For example, the port based channel selection 218 may assign a TC number of 7 to an interconnection 212 port that is or will be used to route transactions from safety application 214 (e.g., high-priority transactions), while the port based channel selection 218 may assign a TC number of 0 to an interconnection 212 port that is or will be used to route transactions from non-safety application 216 (e.g., low-priority transactions).

(31) The port of the interconnect 212 through which a transaction is routed depends at least in part on an attribute associated with that transaction. For example, such an attribute may indicate whether a particular transaction is from the safety application 214 (e.g., a high-priority transaction) or from the non-safety application 216 (e.g., a low-priority transaction). Thus, the traffic access controller 220 assigns each transaction to a specific port of the interconnect 212 based on such an attribute of the transaction. In at least some examples, the traffic access controller 220 assigns transactions from safety application 214 to a port having a high priority TC number (e.g., TC number of 7), and the traffic access controller 220 assigns transactions from non-safety application 216 to a port having a low priority TC number (e.g., TC number of 0). In some examples, multiple attributes may be used by the traffic access controller 220 to assign a particular transaction to a specific port of the interconnect 212.

(32) Responsive to passing through a particular port of the interconnect 212, the transaction assumes (e.g., inherits) the TC number of the TC assigned to that port by the port based channel selection 218. For example, the port based channel selection 218 may assign a TC number of 7 to a particular port of the interconnect 212, meaning that this port is designated for high-priority (e.g., safety-critical) transactions. The traffic access controller 220 may then map a transaction from the safety application 214 to that port based on an attribute of the transaction that indicates the transaction is from the safety application 214, and when that transaction passes through the port, the transaction becomes associated with the TC number 7. As a result of becoming associated with the TC number 7, that transaction is subsequently provided with QoS and isolation from transactions having other TC numbers.

(33) Application manager 222 configures other components within outbound safety isolation unit 206, such as the traffic access controller 220, to select an appropriate port for a transaction. Application manager 222 can be embodied in software in one example.

(34) Safety channel multiplexer 224 receives outbound transactions that have been assigned a TC

as described above and forwards the transactions to a PCIe link (e.g., PCIe link **124** in FIG. **1**), accounting for any QoS restrictions. Specifically, the safety channel multiplexer **224** accesses a TC-to-VC mapping (e.g., in a data structure stored in a memory accessible to the safety channel multiplexer **224**) and determines an appropriate VC for each outbound transaction based on the TC of that transaction. For instance, the safety channel multiplexer **224** may receive a transaction having a TC of 7, and the TC-to-VC mapping may indicate that transactions having a TC of 7 are to be assigned to a first VC. Accordingly, the safety channel multiplexer **224** maps that transaction to the first VC, and it prevents other transactions with other TC numbers from being mapped to the first VC. Subsequent allocations of hardware (e.g., buffers, flow control management, etc.) are made for various transactions based on the VCs they have been assigned by the safety channel multiplexer **224**. In some examples, transactions on certain higher VCs may be guaranteed bandwidth on physical resources, eliminating hardware resource conflicts with lower-priority traffic. In this manner, high priority transactions are prioritized and protected (e.g., isolated) from lower priority transactions. The TC-to-VC mapping may be the mapping specified by the PCIe standard.

(35) In an example operation, a transaction from an application, such as safety application **214** or non-safety application **216**, is received by traffic access controller **220**. Traffic access controller **220** assigns the transaction to a port on interconnect **212** based on an attribute, such as whether the transaction is from a safety application or a non-safety application. The transaction then assumes the TC number of the port as the transaction passes through that port. The TC number determines the VC (e.g., VC0, VC1, . . . , VC7) to which the transaction is assigned. Port based channel selection **218** indicates which port is mapped to which VC, for example, using a data structure that cross-references TC numbers with corresponding VCs. A single PCIe link carries transactions from both safety applications and non-safety applications, but the safety channel multiplexer **224** arbitrates hardware resource allocation between the various transactions according to the transactions' VCs so that end-to-end isolation and QoS is maintained. Additional details of the operations of the components in outbound safety isolation unit **206** are described below with respect to FIG. **4**.

(36) Prior to describing the inbound safety isolation unit **208** of FIG. **2**, a description of various identifiers used in example PCIe systems is provided, as such a description is useful in understanding the function of the inbound safety isolation unit **208**. As described above, in a PCIe system, individual devices may have unique PCIe IDs that are useful to identify network traffic (e.g., transactions) associated with a particular device in the PCIe system. As also described above, individual transactions may have attributes that indicate information about the transactions, such as whether a transaction is from the safety application **214** or the non-safety application **216**. In an example PCIe system, a PCIe ID may be combined with an attribute (e.g., a safety attribute) to form a context ID. Context IDs may also be referred to herein as system-level context IDs.

(37) Referring still to FIG. **2**, inbound safety isolation unit **208** includes application manager **226**, traffic access controller **228**, safety channel demultiplexer **230**, and credential mapping unit **232**. These units within inbound safety isolation unit **208** can each include any combination of hardware and/or software to perform the functions described herein.

(38) The credential mapping unit **232** includes a credential mapping table (e.g., a data structure). In some examples, multiple credential mapping tables are included in the credential mapping unit **232**. A credential mapping table cross-references PCIe IDs with corresponding context IDs. Credential mapping tables in the credential mapping unit **232** may be configured by the application manager **226**. The application manager **226** also may be configured to allocate the context IDs to the credential mapping unit **232**. The credential mapping unit **232** receives a transaction and, based on the PCIe ID of the transaction, the credential mapping unit **232** retrieves a corresponding context ID from the appropriate credential mapping table. (The appropriate credential mapping table is selected based on a VC provided by the safety channel demultiplexer **230**, which is configured to

determine the VC of an incoming transaction based on the TC number associated with that incoming transaction (e.g., using a data structure that cross-references various TC numbers with VCs according to the PCIe standard.) Credential mapping unit **232** subsequently provides the retrieved context ID to traffic access controller **228**.

(39) Traffic access controller **228** enforces memory protection based on context ID. As an example, traffic access controller **228** receives inbound transactions that request access to memory. Traffic access controller **228** determines which regions of memory the transaction is allowed to access based on the source of the transaction (determined by the context ID) or an attribute of the transaction, and then traffic access controller **228** either permits or denies the memory access based on one or more rules. For example, certain regions of memory may only be accessed by safety applications, and not by non-safety applications. Traffic access controller **228** enforces such access restrictions.

(40) In an example operation of inbound safety isolation unit **208**, an incoming transaction first encounters the safety channel demultiplexer **230**. Safety channel demultiplexer **230** decodes the VC associated with the transaction based on the TC number received with the transaction. Credential mapping unit **232** provides a separate credential mapping table for each VC. Based on the VC, one of the credential mapping tables is selected, and the credential mapping table has a unique context ID for each PCIe ID. The credential mapping unit **232** retrieves the context ID from the selected credential mapping table, and it provides the context ID to traffic access controller **228**. Based on that context ID, the traffic access controller **228** can block the transaction from the unauthorized access of a memory location. Additional details of the operations of the components in inbound safety isolation unit **208** are described below with reference to FIG. 3.

(41) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of an inbound safety isolation unit **300** in accordance with various examples. The inbound safety isolation unit **300** is representative of the inbound safety isolation unit **208** in FIG. 2. In some examples, the operation of inbound safety isolation unit **300** is as follows. A transaction **302** enters an inbound (ingress) port **304**. The transaction **302** has a PCIe ID (labeled and referred to as a RequesterID in FIG. 3), which indicates the source of the transaction **302**. Transaction **302** also has a TC number to indicate its traffic class. Transaction **302** also has a PCIe address, which is used to address a memory region in a memory **306**.

(42) After transaction **302** enters inbound port **304**, transaction **302** is received by safety channel demultiplexer **308**. Safety channel demultiplexer **308** is an example of safety channel demultiplexer **230** in FIG. 2. Safety channel demultiplexer **308** uses the TC number associated with the transaction **302** to retrieve a VC for the transaction **302** from the VC to TC mapping specified by the PCIe standard (e.g., stored in a data structure). Based on the VC, safety channel demultiplexer **308** selects one of the credential mapping tables **310**, **312**. Although two credential mapping tables **310**, **312** are shown in FIG. 3, in an example, up to eight credential mapping tables may be included. Credential mapping tables **310**, **312** are examples of the credential mapping tables in credential mapping unit **232** in FIG. 2. In an example, a VC of 7 indicates a safety application, and credential mapping table **310** is selected. In an example, a VC of 0 indicates a non-safety application, and credential mapping table **312** is selected.

(43) The credential mapping tables **310** and **312** store context IDs and may store other attributes (e.g., local QoS attributes). Also, each credential mapping table **310** and **312** has an entry for each requesterID. In an example, if the requesterID associated with a transaction is zero and the attribute (e.g., safety attribute) indicates that the transaction is from a safety application, a corresponding context ID is identified by the respective credential mapping table **310** or **312**. If the transaction attribute indicates that the transaction is from a non-safety application and the requesterID is zero, a different context ID is identified. In some examples, the requesterID alone may be sufficient to identify a corresponding context ID from a credential mapping table **310** or **312**. In some examples, the credential mapping table **310** or **312** may be accessed to identify a local QoS attribute (e.g., local to the SoC) in addition to the context ID for a particular transaction. The context ID and the

local QoS attribute (e.g., safety or non-safety, based on which credential mapping table **310**, **312** is used) are provided to traffic access controller **314**. Traffic access controller **314** receives the context ID, the local QoS attribute (e.g., safety or non-safety), and the transaction **302**, and then it enforces memory protection based on the context ID and the local QoS attribute. In an example of enforcing memory protection, if the local QoS attribute for a transaction indicates a non-safety application, traffic access controller **314** will not permit the transaction to access safety memory region **316**. A transaction from a non-safety application will, however, be permitted to access non-safety memory region **318**.

(44) In some examples, inbound safety isolation unit **300** includes an optional address translation unit (ATU) **320**. PCIe devices use PCIe addresses to send and receive data over a PCIe link. An ATU, such as ATU **320**, translates a device internal address into a PCIe address and vice versa. PCIe addresses associated with inbound transactions are translated by the ATU **320** to retrieve an internal memory address in memory **306**. The request is then transmitted to traffic access controller **314**, and the process continues as described above.

(45) FIG. **4** is a block diagram of an outbound safety isolation unit **400** in accordance with various examples. In examples, the operation of outbound safety isolation unit **400** is as follows. An application initiates a transaction targeting a programmed address in memory. The transaction can be initiated by a safety application, such as safety application **402**. The transaction can also be initiated by a non-safety application, such as non-safety application **404**. The transaction is forwarded to a traffic access controller after it is initiated. The transaction is associated with a local QoS attribute (e.g., indicating whether the transaction is from a safety or non-safety application) that is used to provide a QoS within the SoC. In this example, the traffic access controller is shown as two traffic access controllers **406A** and **406B**, with the traffic access controller **406A** handling transactions from safety applications and the traffic access controller **406B** handling transactions from non-safety applications. In other examples, the traffic access controller can be a single traffic access controller. The traffic access controllers **406A** and **406B** may collectively represent the traffic access controller **220** in FIG. **2**, for example.

(46) After determining whether the transaction is from a safety application or a non-safety application based on the local QoS attribute of the transaction (in the case of a single traffic access controller), traffic access controller **406A** or **406B** selects a port of an interconnect to handle the transaction. Interconnect ports **408A** and **408B** are shown in this example, although a greater number of ports are useful in other examples. In one example, transactions from the safety application **402** will use a different port than transactions from the non-safety application **404**, so a target level of QoS and isolation can be provided for transactions from the safety application **402**. In examples, transactions from the safety application **402** are assigned to port **408A**, and transactions from the non-safety application **404** are assigned to port **408B**. A TC is assigned to each of the port **408A**, **408B**, and based on the port **408A** or **408B** the transaction uses, the transaction assumes the TC number assigned to the port **408A** or **408B** through which the transaction is forwarded. For example, port **408A** may be configured with a TC number of 7, while port **408B** may be configured with a TC number of 0. Transactions flowing through port **408A** assume a TC number of 7, and transactions flowing through port **408B** assume a TC number of 0.

(47) From the port **408A** or **408B**, the transaction is transmitted to the safety channel multiplexer **410**. Safety channel multiplexer **410** is an example of safety channel multiplexer **224** in FIG. **2**. Safety channel multiplexer **410** retrieves the VC corresponding to the TC number associated with a transaction, based on the TC-to-VC mapping that is part of the PCIe standard and that may be stored in a data structure. Safety channel multiplexer **410** then transmits the transaction through an egress port **412** and hardware dedicated to the VC identified for that transaction. The transaction is associated with a PCIe requester ID (e.g., requesterID in FIG. **4**), a TC number, and a PCIe address, the latter of which may be produced by the ATU **414** using a local (e.g., local to the SoC) address. For example, a transaction with a TC number of 7 may be transmitted on hardware corresponding

to a specific VC dedicated to transactions with a TC number of 7.

(48) As described above, the local QoS attribute of the transaction (e.g., safety or non-safety) determines the port used by the transaction. The port used by the transaction, in turn, determines the TC assumed by the transaction. Therefore, the local QoS attribute (e.g., safety or non-safety) is indirectly mapped to the PCIe QoS (e.g., the TC), and a specific quality of service is provided to the transaction in both the SoC that contains outbound safety isolation unit **400** and on the PCIe link (e.g., PCIe link **124** in FIG. **1**). In the inbound safety isolation unit **300** (shown in FIG. **3**), the TC from the PCIe link is mapped to a local QoS attribute, so the quality of service is also maintained within inbound safety isolation unit **300**. The QoS is maintained end-to-end by using both the local QoS attributes and the PCIe QoS.

(49) As alluded to above, outbound safety isolation unit **400** includes an optional outbound ATU **414**. If any part of the transaction is to be forwarded on a PCIe link, the transaction uses PCIe addresses. If an application, such as application **402** or **404**, requests a local address on the SoC, traffic access controller **406A** or **406B** transmits the local address to outbound ATU **414**. Outbound ATU **414** translates the local address to a PCIe address. Also, outbound ATU **414** provides the proper PCIe requester ID for the transaction. The PCIe requester ID is used by an inbound safety isolation unit as described above.

(50) Example implementations can have differentiated classes of applications. A TC can be individually mapped to a VC, or multiple TCs can be mapped to a single VC. A TC number for a transaction is propagated end-to-end in examples herein. The PCIe standard includes eight VCs and eight TCs, but a user may implement a different number of VCs and/or TCs.

(51) To achieve end-to-end isolation for a given application, the application would have its own VC and not share the VC with any other application. Therefore, a safety application may have a dedicated VC in some examples. For applications such as non-safety applications where isolation is not as important, multiple applications could share a VC in some examples.

(52) FIG. **5** is a block diagram of a system **500** for providing end-to-end QoS over PCIe in accordance with various examples. The left side of system **500** shows various components that handle an outbound transaction, while the right side shows various components that handle an inbound transaction. System **500** shows how QoS can be provided from an application on one SoC to an application on another SoC.

(53) System **500** includes a safety application **502** and a non-safety application **504** on the outbound side. Traffic access controller **506** determines which portions of memory can be accessed by which applications. Interconnect **508** shows a safety port **510** and a non-safety port **512**, such as the ports described above with respect to FIG. **4**. Safety port **510** can be a high priority port within interconnect **508**. Safety port **510** can be given priority over non-safety port **512** for QoS.

(54) In an example, a first transaction from safety application **502** can have a quality of service level Local QoS1 associated with the transaction. A second transaction from non-safety application **504** can have a quality of service level Local QoS2 associated with the transaction. The attributes QoS1 and QoS2 can be included with the first and second transactions, respectively. These attributes are used by the other components in system **500** to provide a specific QoS for the respective transactions.

(55) Attributes QoS1 and QoS2 may be used by interconnect **508** to select the priority of transactions on interconnect **508**. For example, one port (such as safety port **510**) could be a high priority port used for QoS1, and one port (such as non-safety port **512**) could be a low priority port used for QoS2. In other examples, there could be more than two levels of priority or QoS.

(56) As described above, a transaction passing through a port will assume the TC assigned to that port. As also described, the PCIe standard includes a TC-to-VC mapping, and thus the PCIe system described herein determines an appropriate VC based on the TC number associated with a particular transaction. FIG. **5** shows four VCs **514**. As described above, up to eight VCs **514** are used to transmit transactions in examples herein. As shown in system **500**, a safety application **502**

may have a dedicated port **510** and dedicated VC, shown here as the leftmost VC (VC7). Conversely, multiple non-safety applications (e.g., non-safety application **504**) may share one or more VCs, depicted in FIG. 5 as the three right-most VCs, including VC0. VC scheduling **516**, such as arbitration of access to hardware or physical components, is then performed by a safety channel multiplexer (e.g., safety channel multiplexer **410** in FIG. 4), and outbound transaction **518** is transmitted over a PCIe link.

(57) VCs **514** and VC scheduling **516** can be aspects of PCIe QoS as defined in the PCIe standard. The examples described herein use the QoS provided by PCIe (e.g., QoS **210** in FIG. 2) along with the components described herein to provide QoS and end-to-end isolation.

(58) On the inbound side of system **500**, inbound transactions **520** are allocated to a queue based on the VC associated with the transaction, as determined using VC mapping **522**. VC mapping **522** can be performed by a safety channel demultiplexer as described above with respect to FIG. 3. Four VCs **524** are shown, with VC7 used for transactions of a safety application, while the other VCs **524** are used for transactions of non-safety applications in this example. Transactions are provided through interconnect **526** and are allocated to the proper queue as described above with respect to FIG. 3. Based on a context ID retrieved by a credential mapping unit (not expressly shown in FIG. 5), a traffic access controller **528** restricts access to certain parts of memory. Transactions may access safety applications **530** and non-safety applications **532**. Traffic access controller **528** also receives the QoS attribute (such as Local QoS1 and Local QoS2) with each transaction, and these attributes are used to provide a QoS on the inbound side of system **500**. Therefore, the QoS for the transactions is maintained from end-to-end.

(59) System **500** illustrates how QoS and isolation can be achieved end-to-end according to examples herein. For example, transactions associated with safety applications **502** or **530** are separated from the non-safety transactions over the entire outbound and inbound paths. Certain transactions from critical applications can have dedicated resources, such as dedicated VCs (and their associated hardware), TCs, ports, traffic access controllers, credential mapping units, and memory.

(60) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of an example method **600** for handling an inbound PCIe transaction in accordance with various examples. Although the method steps are described in conjunction with FIGS. 1, 2, 3, and 5, any system configured to perform the method steps, in any suitable order, falls within the scope of this description. In one example, components of inbound safety isolation unit **300** perform the steps of method **600**.

(61) Method **600** begins at **610**, where an SoC, RC, or endpoint receives a transaction at an inbound port, the transaction including a requesterID, a traffic class, and a PCIe address. As described above in FIG. 3, an SoC, RC, or endpoint receives a PCIe transaction at an inbound port, such as inbound port **304**. The requesterID can be a PCIe ID in an example. The inclusion of the requesterID, traffic class, and PCIe address enables the system to provide end-to-end isolation and QoS as described above.

(62) Method **600** proceeds to **620**, where a demultiplexer such as safety channel demultiplexer **308** generates an attribute based at least in part on the traffic class. In an example, the demultiplexer associates the traffic class with either a safety application or a non-safety application.

(63) Method **600** proceeds to step **630**, where a credential mapping unit, such as credential mapping unit **232**, generates a context ID based on the attribute and the requester ID. The context ID is unique in an example. Multiple credential mapping units **232** and/or credential mapping tables **310** and **312** are used in some examples.

(64) Method **600** proceeds to **640**, where a traffic access controller, such as traffic access controller **314**, accesses a region of memory responsive to the transaction. The region of memory accessed is determined at least in part by the context ID. Context IDs related to safety applications are permitted to access safety regions of memory, such as safety memory region **316**. Context IDs related to non-safety applications are permitted to access non-safety memory regions, such as non-

safety memory region **318**.

(65) FIG. 7 is a flowchart of an example method **700** for handling an outbound PCIe transaction in accordance with various examples. Although the method steps are described in conjunction with FIGS. 1, 2, 4, and 5, any system configured to perform the method steps, in any suitable order, falls within the scope of this description. In one example, components of outbound safety isolation unit **400** perform the steps of method **700**.

(66) Method **700** begins at **710**, where an application generates a transaction, the transaction targeting a programmed address in memory. The transactions can be generated by an application such as safety application **402** or non-safety application **404** in an example. The transactions can be any suitable type of PCIe transaction, such as a read or a write transaction.

(67) Method **700** continues at **720**, where a traffic access controller forwards the transaction to a selected port of an interconnect, the selected port being selected based on an attribute of the application. In an example, a traffic access controller such as traffic access controller **406A** or **406B** (e.g., FIG. 4) forwards the transaction to a port based on an attribute, such as the type of the application associated with the transaction (e.g., a safety application or a non-safety application). Transactions from safety applications can be forwarded to a first port, while transactions from non-safety applications can be forwarded to a second port.

(68) Method **700** continues at **730**, where the selected port applies a traffic class to the transaction, the traffic class based at least in part on the selected port. In one example, each port is associated with a specific TC. Because TCs are mapped to VCs, the port indirectly defines which VC the transaction is assigned to, and associates the transaction to a predefined VC in one example.

(69) Method **700** continues at step **740**, where the transaction is transmitted on a PCIe link, the transaction transmitted with a PCIe ID of the application (e.g., the requesterID), the TC, and the translated PCIe address, as described above. The inclusion of the PCIe requester ID, traffic class, and PCIe address as part of the transaction enables the system to provide end-to-end isolation and QoS, as described above.

(70) Methods and systems described herein realize end-to-end isolation and QoS in a PCIe system. Memory space isolation is provided to isolate memory designated for safety applications from accesses by transactions of non-safety applications. Also, QoS is provided for safety applications.

(71) The term “couple” is used throughout the specification. The term may cover connections, communications, or signal paths that enable a functional relationship consistent with this description. For example, if device A generates a signal to control device B to perform an action, in a first example device A is coupled to device B, or in a second example device A is coupled to device B through intervening component C if intervening component C does not substantially alter the functional relationship between device A and device B such that device B is controlled by device A via the control signal generated by device A.

(72) A device that is “configured to” perform a task or function may be configured (e.g., programmed and/or hardwired) at a time of manufacturing by a manufacturer to perform the function and/or may be configurable (or re-configurable) by a user after manufacturing to perform the function and/or other additional or alternative functions. The configuring may be through firmware and/or software programming of the device, through a construction and/or layout of hardware components and interconnections of the device, or a combination thereof.

(73) Unless otherwise stated, “about,” “approximately,” or “substantially” preceding a value means ± 10 percent of the stated value. Modifications are possible in the described examples, and other examples are possible within the scope of the claims.

Claims

1. A system comprising: a demultiplexer configured to receive a transaction, the transaction including a requester identification (ID), a traffic class, and an address, the demultiplexer further

configured to determine a channel, among a plurality of channels, based on the traffic class of the transaction, each channel being associated with a corresponding mapping table; an access controller configured to obtain, based at least in part on the requester ID, a context ID from the mapping table corresponding to the channel determined by the demultiplexer; and a memory having a first region and a second region, wherein the access controller is further configured to allow the transaction to access the first region of the memory, the first region corresponding to the context ID, and block access to the second region based on the context ID.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the channel determined by the demultiplexer is indicative of a type of application that generated the transaction.

3. The system of claim 1, wherein the access controller is further configured to obtain from the corresponding mapping table a quality of service (QoS) attribute for the transaction.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the address is a peripheral component interconnect express (PCIe) address, the system further comprising: a translation unit coupled to the demultiplexer and configured to translate the PCIe address to a local address to access the first region of memory.

5. A system comprising: a plurality of applications, each of a respective type and each configured to generate transactions, each of which includes an attribute indicating the type of application from which the transaction originated and a target address; an access controller coupled the plurality of applications; a plurality of ports, each having a traffic class, coupled to the access controller; and a multiplexer coupled to the plurality of ports; wherein the access controller is configured to, for a particular transaction among the transactions generated: determine the type of application from which the particular transaction originated, select a port, among the plurality of ports, based on the type of application from which the particular transaction originated, and forward the particular transaction to the selected port; wherein the selected port is configured to transmit the particular transaction to the multiplexer; and wherein the multiplexer is configured to obtain a channel corresponding to the traffic class of the port selected, and transmit the particular transaction through outbound port circuitry for the channel.

6. The system of claim 5, wherein the plurality of applications includes a first application of a safety type and a second application of a non-safety type.

7. The system of claim 5, wherein the attribute of each transaction includes a quality of service (QoS) attribute.

8. The system of claim 7, wherein the access controller is configured to determine the type of application from which the particular transaction originated based on the QoS attribute of the particular transaction, which is mapped to the traffic class of the selected port.

9. The system of claim 5, wherein the access controller is configured to generate a local address based on the target address for the particular transaction.

10. The system of claim 9, further comprising a translation unit coupled to the access controller and configured to translate the local address of the particular transaction to a PCIe address and generate a requester identification (ID) for the particular transaction, the requester ID identifying a PCIe device storing the application.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the multiplexer is further configured to transmit the transaction with the requester ID and the traffic class.

12. A system comprising: a first interconnect configured to: receive a first transaction having a first attribute indicating that the first transaction originated from a first type of application, receive a second transaction having a second attribute indicating that the second transaction originated from a second type of application, select a first pathway to route the first transaction through the first interconnect based on the first attribute, and select a second pathway to route the second transaction through the first interconnect based on the second attribute; and a second interconnect configured to: select a third pathway to route the first transaction through the second interconnect based on the first attribute, and select a fourth pathway to route the second transaction through the second interconnect based on the second attribute.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the first type of application is a safety application, the second type of application is a non-safety application, and the first attribute indicates that the first transaction originated from the safety application and the second transaction originated from the non-safety application.
 14. The system of claim 13, wherein the first pathway is isolated from the second pathway, and the third pathway is isolated from the fourth pathway.
 15. The system of claim 12, where the first attribute includes a first quality of service (QoS) attribute, and the second attribute includes a second QoS attribute.
 16. The system of claim 12, wherein the first interconnect includes a first access controller configured to select the first pathway to route the first transaction through the first interconnect based on the first attribute, and select the second pathway to route the second transaction through the first interconnect based on the second attribute.
 17. The system of claim 16, wherein the second interconnect includes a second access controller configured to determine which portion of a destination the first transaction is allowed to access based on the first attribute, and determine which portion of the destination the second transaction is allowed to access based on the second attribute.
 18. The system of claim 17, wherein the second access controller is configured to determine that the first transaction is allowed to access a safety portion of the destination based on the first attribute, and that the second transaction is not allowed to access the safety portion of the destination based on the second attribute.
 19. The system of claim 12, wherein the first attribute includes a first traffic class, the second attribute includes a second traffic class, and the first interconnect includes a mapping table that maps the first traffic class to the first pathway and maps the second traffic class to the second pathway.
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